

Integrative Dentistry's Financial Policy

Payments

Integrative Dentistry asks for payment in full at the time of service. We accept Cash, Checks, Debit, and Credit Cards including Visa, MasterCard, Discover, and American Express. We also accept deferred payments via Tula Pay or Care Credit (6-month and 12-month options for qualifying payments).

Integrative Dentistry offers a discount of five percent (5%) if you pay in full for treatment on the day your treatment plan is created or at least 2 weeks in advance of your appointment for that treatment. "Treatment" includes fillings, crowns, extractions, and implants; treatment does **NOT** include cleanings or exams. A five-percent (5%) discount is also available if treatment is paid for in full by cash at any time. "Cash" means physical United States currency or coins, **not including** checks, debit, or credit cards. Both of these discounts may be utilized together for a total of a ten-percent (10%) discount.

If the bank returns a check, a fifty-dollar (\$50) fee will be applied to your account. If the check is over \$500, the cost will be seventy-five (\$75) dollars.

Separated or divorced parents of minors who have a split-payment parenting plan are still responsible for payment in full at the time of service. To facilitate the matter, we can hold two credit cards on file that can be used for these payments. Still, parents must handle any insurance payment involvement or other agreements outside of Integrative Dentistry. We will not mediate any payment structures within the office.

Broken Appointments

Appointments are considered *broken* when they are missed (you show up later than 15 minutes after your scheduled appointment time, or do not show up at all) or canceled with less than 2 business days' notice* from the scheduled appointment time. Integrative Dentistry is open Monday through Thursday, and those are considered our business days when canceling appointments. **Cancellations starting after 3:00 PM on Thursday through Monday at 6:59 AM are not considered within business hours. They will not count as enough notice if canceling for Monday or Tuesday, for example.**

*Appointments with Dr. Jeannette Daneals require only a 24-hour notice (Monday appointments must be canceled by the prior Thursday).

For any appointments over 90 minutes, we require a credit card on file. We will not hold this appointment with a deposit; if you cancel outside our acceptable cancellation time frame, we will charge the fee to the provided card.

We know life happens, and sometimes unforeseen circumstances such as weather, sickness, and last-minute emergencies arise. Regardless of the reason for your broken appointment or the length of your tenure as a patient of the practice, because we are a small family-owned business with little to no profit margin, we simply cannot afford to bear the financial burden of maintaining clinical employees on premises when you are unable to be here for a scheduled appointment. Our cancellation fee exists SOLELY so we can pay those assistants, hygienists, and doctors already scheduled to be here for your appointment. The 2-day notification requirement exists so we have enough time to try to fill your appointment and help you avoid the cancellation fee. When an appointment is broken, we cannot simply ask those employees not to work as they depend on a regular work schedule and regular pay to meet the financial demands of their lives.

The fee for a broken appointment with our hygienists is \$155 per hour. The fee for a broken appointment with one of our dentists is \$200 per hour. The fee for a broken appointment with Dr. Daneals is 50% of the scheduled treatment. Our office enforces the fee as a *last resort*, and we will work hard to spare you the charge when possible. We will not charge you in the following circumstances:

- You fill another open appointment on the same day
- Your appointment is filled either by a family member or another patient
- Your appointment is at the beginning or end of the working day, and the affected employees agree to start late or leave early for the day.

On the other hand, our office offers a last-minute appointment-filling credit for patients who take spots available within 1 to 2 days. The credit is \$50 for appointments filled 2 days out and \$75 for appointments filled the same day or the next day. This is to reward patients for helping other patients avoid a late-cancelation fee.

Our office also strives to limit last-minute provider cancellations and to fulfill the appointment you schedule every time. While rare, in the event of a provider-based cancellation or rescheduling within our 2-business-day cancellation policy, we will credit your account \$50 to be used toward your next visit.

Refunds

All approved refund requests are processed by our bookkeeper in California, who works only one day per month. All refunds are processed by paper check and mailed by USPS. The bookkeeper can work to process approved refund requests only on their scheduled day, and mailed checks will arrive according to standard USPS timelines, which are out of our control. Once a refund request has been approved, you can expect a turnaround time of 6-8 weeks.

If work is not completed to your satisfaction, refund requests can only be approved at the sole discretion of the treating dentist who provided that work. Hygienists cannot approve refund requests, and all services or procedures provided by your hygienist are nonrefundable. Because of the medicolegal relationship between a patient and their doctor, neither the office manager nor the practice owner can authorize a refund on dental procedures or services. Please note that product purchases (e.g. toothpaste or mouthrinses) are nonrefundable once the safety seal has been broken.

Our dentists and hygienists reserve the right to examine and document any issues of concern, and attempt to provide relief, remedy, or redo the work, if possible. If you instead elect to seek care elsewhere, you forfeit your right to a refund as your provider was not given the chance to confirm your claim, fix the problem, or reattempt the procedure. If you would like to seek a second opinion within our office, we can often (not always) facilitate a consultation with one of our other doctors or hygienists, at their discretion.

If all internal options have been exhausted, and the dental work still cannot be completed to your satisfaction, services and procedures performed by your dentist are only eligible for a partial refund, except procedure code *D0120 - Periodic Examination*, which is eligible for a full refund. Because 60% of the money you pay towards your dental care is immediately expensed on irrecoverable costs incurred in the provision or performance of a dental procedure, you agree to commit 60% of money paid in exchange for dental work to the mere attempt to provide said work; that 60% is nonrefundable. The remaining 40% is refundable at the sole discretion of the dentist who performed the disputed work. All services or procedures performed by your hygienist are nonrefundable.

In the event that a refund request is approved, you will be asked to sign a *Refund Release and Settlement Form* before we can forward your approved refund request to our bookkeeper.

Insurances and Claim Filing

Integrative Dentistry is out of network with all insurances. However, if you have a dental PPO plan, our office can bill them on your behalf for reimbursement as a courtesy. This is commonly referred to as "back-end billing," meaning you pay in full at the time of service. We submit any claims to your dental insurance and ask them to reimburse you directly if your plan allows that. Be aware that if you have Medicare, Medicaid, or a "State" plan, we cannot bill them, as they do not accept claims from out-of-network providers.

Our office is not an insurance-driven practice. As a holistic dentist, we use the highest-quality materials, equipment, technology, and providers. Dental insurance companies do not pay for the inherent higher cost of these things. Because of this, we do not contract with insurance companies or accept payment assignments from them. We do not let insurance dictate our practices for the sake of the health of our patients looking for the best in modern holistic dental care.

Please be sure to provide all accurate information on your paperwork or to our billing coordinator, as we will only submit claims based on the information provided. If nothing is provided via paperwork or directly to us, we will assume there is no insurance to bill. We do not routinely ask for insurance information but instead rely on our patients to disclose and inform us of their insurance status.

Remember that all insurances are vastly different, especially dental insurance! This means that even with the same insurance brand, your policy can be very different when compared to another person under the same brand. Insurance also can handle claims very slowly, with the average turn-around time being about 6 to 8 weeks, although insurance adjusters are allowed up to 90 days to fully process claims. We ask that you patiently wait for reimbursement for 60 days before calling to inquire about your claim's status. Many insurance agents will not be able to see your claim in their customer service system until it is fully processed. After 60 days, if you have not received a check from your insurance and they have no claim on file for you, we will verify the information you provided us and happily submit another claim for you once more. If the insurance still does not receive it after that or denies the claim, the last option is to send you a copy of an itemized statement for that date of service so that you can attempt to file a claim on your side.

Dental insurances tend to inform patients - either at sign-up or when called - a list of percentages that procedures are covered at. This description of benefits tends to leave out a few, very key details: these benefits are described for either in-network services or based on an insurance's usual, customary, or reasonable fee ("UCR"). The benefits that

are determined are based on those fees, not ours, and make the effective coverage percentage lower than the reported amount. These benefits come from the insurance, not our office, based on their own set fee-schedules they determined using some proprietary and arbitrary formula for your area.

Interest Rates on Balances Due

Any balances not paid for at the time of service are subject to a one-and-one-half percent (1.5%) interest rate per month. Interest is accrued at the start of each month, starting the month following the initial invoice date. As per Washington law, a maximum of twelve percent (12%) can accrue each calendar year.

If a payment plan has been discussed prior to the balance, this fee will be waived so long as the plan remains in good standing. If the good-faith plan falls delinquent—i.e., a payment is not made on the agreed-upon date before the end of the business day—interest will accrue for each month since the balance started.